12 2Ki · 2 Kings

1 After the death of Ahab, Moab rebelled against Israel. [2] Now Ahaziah had fallen
through the lattice of his upper room in Samaria and injured himself. So he sent
messengers and instructed them: "Go inquire of Baal-zebub, the god of Ekron,
whether I will recover from this injury." [3] But the angel of the LORD said to
Elijah the Tishbite, "Go up to meet the messengers of the king of Samaria and ask
them, 'Is it because there is no God in Israel that you are on your way to inquire
of Baal-zebub, the god of Ekron?'" [4] "Therefore this is what the LORD says: 'You
will not get up from the bed on which you are lying. You will surely die.'" So
Elijah departed. [5] When the messengers returned to the king, he asked them, "Why
have you returned?" [6] They replied, "A man came up to meet us and said, 'Go back
to the king who sent you and tell him that this is what the LORD says: Is it because
there is no God in Israel that you are sending these men to inquire of Baal-zebub, the
god of Ekron? Therefore you will not get up from the bed on which you are lying.
You will surely die.'" [7] The king asked them, "What sort of man came up to meet
you and spoke these words to you?" [8] "He was a hairy man," they answered, "with
a leather belt around his waist." "It was Elijah the Tishbite," said the king. [9] Then
King Ahaziah sent to Elijah a captain with his company of fifty men. So the captain
went up to Elijah, who was sitting on top of a hill, and said to him, "Man of God,
the king declares, 'Come down!'" [10] Elijah answered the captain, "If I am a man of
God, may fire come down from heaven and consume you and your fifty men." And
fire came down from heaven and consumed the captain and his fifty men. [11] So the
king sent to Elijah another captain with his fifty men. And the captain said to Elijah,
"Man of God, the king declares, 'Come down at once!'" [12] Again Elijah replied, "If
I am a man of God, may fire come down from heaven and consume you and your
fifty men." And the fire of God came down from heaven and consumed the captain
and his fifty men. [13] So the king sent a third captain with his fifty men. And the third
captain went up, fell on his knees before Elijah, and begged him, "Man of God, may
my life and the lives of these fifty servants please be precious in your sight."

[14] "Behold, fire has come down from heaven and consumed the first two captains
of fifty, with all their men. But now may my life be precious in your sight." [15] Then
the angel of the LORD said to Elijah, "Go down with him. Do not be afraid of
him." So Elijah got up and went down with him to the king. [16] And Elijah said to
King Ahaziah, "This is what the LORD says: Is there really no God in Israel for you
to inquire of His word? Is that why you have sent messengers to inquire of Baal-
zebub, the god of Ekron? Therefore you will not get up from the bed on which
you are lying. You will surely die." [17] So Ahaziah died according to the word of the
LORD that Elijah had spoken. And since he had no son, Jehoram succeeded him in
the second year of the reign of Jehoram son of Jehoshaphat over Judah. [18] As for the
rest of the acts of Ahaziah, along with his accomplishments, are they not written in
the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel?

2 Shortly before the LORD took Elijah up to heaven in a whirlwind, Elijah and
Elisha were on their way from Gilgal, [2] and Elijah said to Elisha, "Please stay here, for
the LORD has sent me on to Bethel." But Elisha replied, "As surely as the LORD
lives and as you yourself live, I will not leave you." So they went down to Bethel.
[3] Then the sons of the prophets at Bethel came out to Elisha and said, "Do you
know that the LORD will take your master away from you today?" "Yes, I know,"
he replied. "Do not speak of it." [4] And Elijah said to Elisha, "Please stay here, for
the LORD has sent me on to Jericho." But Elisha replied, "As surely as the LORD
lives and as you yourself live, I will not leave you." So they went to Jericho. [5] Then
the sons of the prophets at Jericho came up to Elisha and said, "Do you know that
the LORD will take your master away from you today?" "Yes, I know," he replied.
"Do not speak of it." [6] And Elijah said to Elisha, "Please stay here, for the LORD
has sent me on to the Jordan." But Elisha replied, "As surely as the LORD lives and
as you yourself live, I will not leave you." So the two of them went on. [7] Then a
company of fifty of the sons of the prophets went and stood at a distance, facing
Elijah and Elisha as the two of them stood by the Jordan.

[8] And Elijah took his cloak, rolled it up, and struck the waters, which parted to
the right and to the left, so that the two of them crossed over on dry ground. [9] After
they had crossed over, Elijah said to Elisha, "Tell me, what can I do for you before I
am taken away from you?" "Please, let me inherit a double portion of your spirit,"
Elisha replied. [10] "You have requested a difficult thing," said Elijah. "Nevertheless,
if you see me as I am taken from you, it will be yours. But if not, then it will not
be so." [11] As they were walking along and talking together, suddenly a chariot of fire
with horses of fire appeared and separated the two of them, and Elijah went up into
heaven in a whirlwind.

[12] As Elisha watched, he cried out, "My father, my father, the chariots and horsemen
of Israel!" And he saw Elijah no more. So taking hold of his own clothes, he tore
them in two. [13] Elisha also picked up the cloak that had fallen from Elijah, and he
went back and stood on the bank of the Jordan. [14] Then he took the cloak of Elijah
that had fallen from him and struck the waters. "Where now is the LORD, the God
of Elijah?" he asked. And when he had struck the waters, they parted to the right and
to the left, and Elisha crossed over. [15] When the sons of the prophets who were facing
him from Jericho saw what had happened, they said, "The spirit of Elijah rests on
Elisha." And they went to meet him and bowed down to the ground before him.

[16] "Look now," they said to Elisha, "we your servants have fifty valiant men. Please
let them go and search for your master. Perhaps the Spirit of the LORD has taken
him up and put him on one of the mountains or in one of the valleys." "Do not send
them," Elisha replied. [17] But when they pressed him to the point of embarrassment,
he said, "Send them." And they sent fifty men, who searched for three days but did
not find Elijah. [18] When they returned to Elisha, who was staying in Jericho, he said
to them, "Didn't I tell you not to go?" [19] Then the men of the city said to Elisha,
"Please note, our lord, that the city's location is good, as you can see. But the water
is bad and the land is unfruitful." [20] "Bring me a new bowl," he replied, "and put
some salt in it." So they brought it to him, [21] and Elisha went out to the spring, cast
the salt into it, and said, "This is what the LORD says: 'I have healed this water.
No longer will it cause death or unfruitfulness.'" [22] And the waters there have been
healthy to this day, according to the word spoken by Elisha. [23] From there, Elisha
went up to Bethel, and as he was walking up the road, a group of boys came out of
the city and jeered at him, chanting, "Go up, you baldhead! Go up, you baldhead!"
[24] Then he turned around, looked at them, and called down a curse on them in the
name of the LORD. Suddenly two female bears came out of the woods and mauled
forty-two of the boys. [25] And Elisha went on to Mount Carmel, and from there he
returned to Samaria.

3 In the eighteenth year of Jehoshaphat's reign over Judah, Jehoram son of Ahab
became king of Israel, and he reigned in Samaria twelve years. [2] And he did evil in
the sight of the LORD, but not as his father and mother had done. He removed
the sacred pillar of Baal that his father had made. [3] Nevertheless, he clung to the
sins that Jeroboam son of Nebat had caused Israel to commit; he did not turn
away from them. [4] Now Mesha king of Moab was a sheep breeder, and he would
render to the king of Israel a hundred thousand lambs and the wool of a hundred
thousand rams. [5] But after the death of Ahab, the king of Moab rebelled against the
king of Israel. [6] So at that time King Jehoram set out from Samaria and mobilized
all Israel. [7] And he sent a message to Jehoshaphat king of Judah: "The king of Moab
has rebelled against me. Will you go with me to fight against Moab?" "I will go,"
replied Jehoshaphat. "I am like you, my people are your people, and my horses are
your horses." [8] Then he asked, "Which way shall we go up?" "By way of the Desert
of Edom," replied Joram.

[9] So the king of Israel, the king of Judah, and the king of Edom set out, and
after they had traveled a roundabout route for seven days, they had no water for
their army or for their animals. [10] "Alas," said the king of Israel, "for the LORD
has summoned these three kings to deliver them into the hand of Moab!" [11] But
Jehoshaphat asked, "Is there no prophet of the LORD here? Let us inquire of
the LORD through him." And one of the servants of the king of Israel answered,
"Elisha son of Shaphat is here. He used to pour water on the hands of Elijah."
[12] Jehoshaphat affirmed, "The word of the LORD is with him." So the king of Israel
and Jehoshaphat and the king of Edom went down to him.

[13] Elisha, however, said to the king of Israel, "What have we to do with each other?
Go to the prophets of your father and of your mother!" "No," replied the king of
Israel, "for it is the LORD who has summoned these three kings to deliver them
into the hand of Moab." [14] Then Elisha said, "As surely as the LORD of Hosts lives,
before whom I stand, were it not for my regard for the presence of Jehoshaphat king
of Judah, I would not look at you or acknowledge you." [15] "But now, bring me a
harpist." And while the harpist played, the hand of the LORD came upon Elisha
[16] and he said, "This is what the LORD says: 'Dig this valley full of ditches.'" [17] For
the LORD says, 'You will not see wind or rain, but the valley will be filled with
water, and you will drink—you and your cattle and your animals.'

[18] This is a simple matter in the sight of the LORD, and He will also deliver the
Moabites into your hand. [19] "And you shall attack every fortified city and every city
of importance. You shall cut down every good tree, stop up every spring, and ruin
every good field with stones." [20] The next morning, at the time of the morning
sacrifice, water suddenly flowed from the direction of Edom and filled the land.
[21] Now all the Moabites had heard that the kings had come up to fight against
them. So all who could bear arms, young and old, were summoned and stationed
at the border. [22] When they got up early in the morning, the sun was shining on
the water, and it looked as red as blood to the Moabites across the way. [23] "This
is blood!" they exclaimed. "The kings have clashed swords and slaughtered one
another. Now to the plunder, Moab!" [24] But when the Moabites came to the camp
of Israel, the Israelites rose up and attacked them, and they fled before them. So the
Israelites invaded their land and struck down the Moabites. [25] They destroyed the
cities, and each man threw stones on every good field until it was covered. They
stopped up every spring and cut down every good tree. Only Kir-haraseth was left
with stones in place, but men with slings surrounded it and attacked it as well.

[26] When the king of Moab saw that the battle was too fierce for him, he took with him seven hundred swordsmen to break through to the king of Edom, but they could not prevail. [27] So he took his firstborn son, who was to succeed him, and offered him as a burnt offering on the city wall. And there was great fury against the Israelites, so they withdrew and returned to their own land.

4 Now the wife of one of the sons of the prophets cried out to Elisha, "Your servant, my husband, is dead, and you know that your servant feared the LORD. And now his creditor is coming to take my two children as his slaves!" [2] "How can I help you?" asked Elisha. "Tell me, what do you have in the house?" She answered, "Your servant has nothing in the house but a jar of oil." [3] "Go," said Elisha, "borrow jars, even empty ones, from all your neighbors. Do not gather just a few." [4] "Then go inside, shut the door behind you and your sons, and pour oil into all these jars, setting the full ones aside." [5] So she left him, and after she had shut the door behind her and her sons, they kept bringing jars to her, and she kept pouring. [6] When all the jars were full, she said to her son, "Bring me another." But he replied, "There are no more jars." Then the oil stopped flowing. [7] She went and told the man of God, and he said, "Go, sell the oil, and pay your debt. Then you and your sons can live on the remainder." [8] One day Elisha went to Shunem, and a prominent woman who lived there persuaded him to have a meal. So whenever he would pass by, he would stop there to eat. [9] Then the woman said to her husband, "Behold, now I know that the one who often comes our way is a holy man of God." [10] "Please let us make a small room upstairs and put in it a bed, a table, a chair, and a lamp for him. Then when he comes to us, he can stay there." [11] One day Elisha came to visit and went to his upper room to lie down. [12] And he said to Gehazi his servant, "Call the Shunammite woman." And when he had called her, she stood before him, [13] and Elisha said to Gehazi, "Now tell her, 'Look, you have gone to all this trouble for us. What can we do for you? Can we speak on your behalf to the king or the commander of the army?'" "I have a home among my own people," she replied.

[14] So he asked, "Then what should be done for her?" "Well, she has no son," Gehazi replied, "and her husband is old." [15] "Call her," said Elisha. So Gehazi called her, and she stood in the doorway. [16] And Elisha declared, "At this time next year, you will hold a son in your arms." "No, my lord," she said. "Do not lie to your maidservant, O man of God." [17] But the woman did conceive, and at that time the next year she gave birth to a son, just as Elisha had told her. [18] And the child grew, and one day he went out to his father, who was with the harvesters.

[19] "My head! My head!" he complained to his father. So his father told a servant, "Carry him to his mother." [20] After the servant had picked him up and carried him to his mother, the boy sat on her lap until noon, and then he died. [21] And she went up and laid him on the bed of the man of God. Then she shut the door and went out. [22] And the woman called her husband and said, "Please send me one of the servants and one of the donkeys, that I may go quickly to the man of God and return." [23] "Why would you go to him today?" he replied. "It is not a New Moon or a Sabbath." "Everything is all right," she said. [24] Then she saddled the donkey and told her servant, "Drive onward; do not slow the pace for me unless I tell you." [25] So she set out and went to the man of God at Mount Carmel. When the man of God saw her at a distance, he said to his servant Gehazi, "Look, there is the Shunammite woman." [26] "Please run out now to meet her and ask, 'Are you all right? Is your husband all right? Is your child all right?'" And she answered, "Everything is all right." [27] When she reached the man of God at the mountain, she clung to his feet. Gehazi came over to push her away, but the man of God said, "Leave her alone, for her soul is in deep distress, and the LORD has hidden it from me and has not told me." [28] Then she said, "Did I ask you for a son, my lord? Didn't I say, 'Do not deceive me?'"

[29] So Elisha said to Gehazi, "Tie up your garment, take my staff in your hand, and go! If you meet anyone, do not greet him, and if anyone greets you, do not answer him. Then lay my staff on the boy's face." [30] And the mother of the boy said, "As surely as the LORD lives and as you yourself live, I will not leave you." So he got up and followed her. [31] Gehazi went on ahead of them and laid the staff on the boy's face, but there was no sound or response. So he went back to meet Elisha and told him, "The boy has not awakened." [32] When Elisha reached the house, there was the boy lying dead on his bed. [33] So he went in, closed the door behind the two of them, and prayed to the LORD. [34] Then Elisha got on the bed and lay on the boy, mouth to mouth, eye to eye, and hand to hand. As he stretched himself out over him, the boy's body became warm. [35] Elisha turned away and paced back and forth across the room. Then he got on the bed and stretched himself out over the boy again, and the boy sneezed seven times and opened his eyes. [36] Elisha summoned Gehazi and said, "Call the Shunammite woman." So he called her and she came. Then Elisha said, "Pick up your son." [37] She came in, fell at his feet, and bowed to the ground. Then she picked up her son and went out. [38] When Elisha returned to Gilgal, there was a famine in the land. As the sons of the prophets were sitting at his feet, he said to his attendant, "Put on the large pot and boil some stew for the sons of the prophets." [39] One of them went out to the field to gather herbs, and he found a wild vine from which he gathered as many wild gourds as his garment could hold. Then he came back and cut them up into the pot of stew, though no one knew what they were. [40] And they poured it out for the men to eat, but when they tasted the stew they cried out, "There is death in the pot, O man of God!" And they could not eat it. [41] Then Elisha said, "Get some flour." He threw it into the pot and said, "Pour it out for the people to eat." And there was nothing harmful in the pot. [42] Now a man from Baal-shalishah came to the man of God with a sack of twenty loaves of barley bread from the first ripe grain. "Give it to the people to eat," said Elisha. [43] But his servant asked, "How am I to set twenty loaves before a hundred men?" "Give it to the people to eat," said Elisha, "for this is what the LORD says: 'They will eat and have some left over.'" [44] So he set it before them, and they ate and had some left over, according to the word of the LORD.

5 Now Naaman, the commander of the army of the king of Aram, was a great man in his master's sight and highly regarded, for through him the LORD had given victory to Aram. And he was a mighty man of valor, but he was a leper. [2] At this time the Arameans had gone out in bands and had taken a young girl from the land of Israel, and she was serving Naaman's wife. [3] She said to her mistress, "If only my master would go to the prophet who is in Samaria, he would cure him of his leprosy." [4] And Naaman went and told his master what the girl from the land of Israel had said. [5] "Go now," said the king of Aram, "and I will send you with a letter to the king of Israel." So Naaman departed, taking with him ten talents of silver, six thousand shekels of gold, and ten sets of clothing. [6] And the letter that he took to the king of Israel stated: "With this letter I am sending my servant Naaman, so that you may cure him of his leprosy." [7] When the king of Israel read the letter, he tore his clothes and asked, "Am I God, killing and giving life, that this man expects me to cure a leper? Surely you can see that he is seeking a quarrel with me!" [8] Now when Elisha the man of God heard that the king of Israel had torn his clothes, he sent a message to the king: "Why have you torn your clothes? Please let the man come to me, and he will know that there is a prophet in Israel."

[9] So Naaman came with his horses and chariots and stood at the door of Elisha's house. [10] Then Elisha sent him a messenger, who said, "Go and wash yourself seven times in the Jordan, and your flesh will be restored, and you will be clean." [11] But Naaman went away angry, saying, "I thought that he would surely come out, stand and call on the name of the LORD his God, and wave his hand over the spot to cure my leprosy." [12] "Are not the Abanah and Pharpar, the rivers of Damascus, better than all the waters of Israel? Could I not have washed in them and been cleansed?" So he turned and went away in a rage. [13] Naaman's servants, however, approached him and said, "My father, if the prophet had told you to do some great thing, would you not have done it? How much more, then, when he tells you, 'Wash and be cleansed'?" [14] So Naaman went down and dipped himself in the Jordan seven times, according to the word of the man of God, and his flesh was restored and became like that of a little child, and he was clean. [15] Then Naaman and all his attendants went back to the man of God, stood before him, and declared, "Now I know for sure that there is no God in all the earth except in Israel. So please accept a gift from your servant."

[16] But Elisha replied, "As surely as the LORD lives, before whom I stand, I will not accept it." And although Naaman urged him to accept it, he refused. [17] "If you will not," said Naaman, "please let me, your servant, be given as much soil as a pair of mules can carry. For your servant will never again make a burnt offering or a sacrifice to any other god but the LORD."

[18] "Yet may the LORD forgive your servant this one thing: When my master goes into the temple of Rimmon to worship there, and he leans on my arm, and I bow down in the temple of Rimmon, may the LORD forgive your servant in this matter." [19] "Go in peace," said Elisha. But after Naaman had traveled a short distance, [20] Gehazi, the servant of Elisha the man of God, said, "Look, my master has spared this Aramean, Naaman, while not accepting what he brought. As surely as the LORD lives, I will run after him and get something from him." [21] So Gehazi pursued Naaman. And when Naaman saw him running toward him, he got down from the chariot to meet him and asked, "Is everything all right?" [22] "Everything is all right," Gehazi replied. "My master has sent me to say, 'I have just now discovered that two young men from the sons of the prophets have come to me from the hill country of Ephraim. Please give them a talent of silver and two sets of clothing.'" [23] But Naaman insisted, "Please, take two talents." And he urged Gehazi to accept them. Then he tied up two talents of silver in two bags along with two sets of clothing and gave them to two of his servants, who carried them ahead of Gehazi. [24] When Gehazi came to the hill, he took the gifts from the servants and stored them in the house. Then he dismissed the men, and they departed. [25] When Gehazi went in and stood before his master, Elisha asked him, "Gehazi, where have you been?" "Your servant did not go anywhere," he replied. [26] But Elisha questioned him, "Did not my spirit go with you when the man got down from his chariot to meet you? Is this the time to accept money and clothing, olive groves and vineyards, sheep and oxen, menservants and maidservants?" [27] "Therefore, the leprosy of Naaman will cling to you and your descendants forever!" And as Gehazi left his presence, he was leprous—as white as snow.

6 Now the sons of the prophets said to Elisha, "Please take note that the place where we meet with you is too small for us." [2] "Please let us go to the Jordan, where each of us can get a log so we can build ourselves a place to live there." "Go,"

said Elisha. [3] Then one of them said, "Please come with your servants." "I will come," he replied. [4] So Elisha went with them, and when they came to the Jordan, they began to cut down some trees. [5] As one of them was cutting down a tree, the iron axe head fell into the water. "Oh, my master," he cried out, "it was borrowed!" [6] "Where did it fall?" asked the man of God. And when he showed him the place, the man of God cut a stick, threw it there, and made the iron float. [7] "Lift it out," he said, and the man reached out his hand and took it. [8] Now the king of Aram was at war against Israel. After consulting with his servants, he said, "My camp will be in such and such a place." [9] Then the man of God sent word to the king of Israel: "Be careful passing by this place, for the Arameans are going down there." [10] So the king of Israel sent word to the place the man of God had pointed out. Time and again Elisha warned the king, so that he was on his guard in such places.

[11] For this reason the king of Aram became enraged and called his servants to demand of them, "Tell me, which one of us is on the side of the king of Israel?" [12] But one of his servants replied, "No one, my lord the king. For Elisha, the prophet in Israel, tells the king of Israel the very words you speak in your bedroom." [13] So the king said, "Go and see where he is, that I may send men to capture him." On receiving the report, "Elisha is in Dothan," [14] the king of Aram sent horses, chariots, and a great army. They went there by night and surrounded the city. [15] When the servant of the man of God got up and went out early in the morning, an army with horses and chariots had surrounded the city. So he asked Elisha, "Oh, my master, what are we to do?" [16] "Do not be afraid," Elisha answered, "for those who are with us are more than those who are with them." [17] Then Elisha prayed, "O LORD, please open his eyes that he may see." And the LORD opened the eyes of the young man, and he saw that the hills were full of horses and chariots of fire all around Elisha. [18] As the Arameans came down against him, Elisha prayed to the LORD, "Please strike these people with blindness." So He struck them with blindness, according to the word of Elisha. [19] And Elisha told them, "This is not the way, and this is not the city. Follow me, and I will take you to the man you are seeking." And he led them to Samaria. [20] When they had entered Samaria, Elisha said, "O LORD, open the eyes of these men that they may see." Then the LORD opened their eyes, and they looked around and discovered that they were in Samaria. [21] And when the king of Israel saw them, he asked Elisha, "My father, shall I kill them? Shall I kill them?"

[22] "Do not kill them," he replied. "Would you kill those you have captured with your own sword or bow? Set food and water before them, that they may eat and drink and then return to their master." [23] So the king prepared a great feast for them, and after they had finished eating and drinking, he sent them away, and they returned to their master. And the Aramean raiders did not come into the land of Israel again. [24] Some time later, Ben-hadad king of Aram assembled his entire army and marched up to besiege Samaria. [25] So there was a great famine in Samaria. Indeed, they besieged the city so long that a donkey's head sold for eighty shekels of silver, and a quarter cab of dove's dung sold for five shekels of silver. [26] As the king of Israel was passing by on the wall, a woman cried out to him, "Help me, my lord the king!" [27] He answered, "If the LORD does not help you, where can I find help for you? From the threshing floor or the winepress?" [28] Then the king asked her, "What is the matter?" And she answered, "This woman said to me, 'Give up your son, that we may eat him, and tomorrow we will eat my son.'" [29] "So we boiled my son and ate him, and the next day I said to her, 'Give up your son, that we may eat him.' But she had hidden her son." [30] When the king heard the words of the woman, he tore his clothes. And as he passed by on the wall, the people saw the sackcloth under his clothes next to his skin. [31] He announced, "May God punish me, and ever so severely, if the head of Elisha son of Shaphat remains on his shoulders through this day!" [32] Now Elisha was sitting in his house, and the elders were sitting with him. The king sent a messenger ahead, but before he arrived, Elisha said to the elders, "Do you see how this murderer has sent someone to cut off my head? Look, when the messenger comes, shut the door to keep him out. Is not the sound of his master's footsteps behind him?" [33] While Elisha was still speaking with them, the messenger came down to him. And the king said, "This calamity is from the LORD. Why should I wait for the LORD any longer?"

7 Then Elisha said, "Hear the word of the LORD! This is what the LORD says: 'About this time tomorrow at the gate of Samaria, a seah of fine flour will sell for a shekel, and two seahs of barley will sell for a shekel.'" [2] But the officer on whose arm the king leaned answered the man of God, "Look, even if the LORD were to make windows in heaven, could this really happen?" "You will see it with your own eyes," replied Elisha, "but you will not eat any of it." [3] Now there were four men with leprosy at the entrance of the city gate, and they said to one another, "Why just sit here until we die? [4] "If we say, 'Let us go into the city,' we will die there from the famine in the city; but if we sit here, we will also die. So come now, let us go over to the camp of the Arameans. If they let us live, we will live; if they kill us, we will die." [5] So they arose at twilight and went to the camp of the Arameans. But when they came to the outskirts of the camp, there was not a man to be found. [6] For the Lord had caused the Arameans to hear the sound of chariots, horses, and a great army, so that they said to one another, "Look, the king of Israel must have hired the kings of the Hittites and Egyptians to attack us." [7] Thus the Arameans had arisen and fled at twilight, abandoning their tents and horses and donkeys. The camp was intact, and they had run for their lives. [8] When the lepers reached the edge of the camp, they went into a tent to eat and drink. Then they carried off the silver, gold, and clothing, and went and hid them. On returning, they entered another tent, carried off some items from there, and hid them. [9] Finally, they said to one another, "We are not doing what is right. Today is a day of good news. If we are silent and wait until morning light, our sin will overtake us. Now, therefore, let us go and tell the king's household." [10] So they went and called out to the gatekeepers of the city, saying, "We went to the Aramean camp and no one was there—not a trace—only tethered horses and donkeys, and the tents were intact." [11] The gatekeepers shouted the news, and it was reported to the king's household. [12] So the king got up in the night and said to his servants, "Let me tell you what the Arameans have done to us. They know we are starving, so they have left the camp to hide in the field, thinking, 'When they come out of the city, we will take them alive and enter the city.'"

[13] But one of his servants replied, "Please, have scouts take five of the horses that remain in the city. Their plight will be no worse than all the Israelites who are left here. You can see that all the Israelites here are doomed. So let us send them and find out." [14] Then the scouts took two chariots with horses, and the king sent them after the Aramean army, saying, "Go and see." [15] And they tracked them as far as the Jordan, and indeed, the whole way was littered with the clothing and equipment the Arameans had thrown off in haste. So the scouts returned and told the king. [16] Then the people went out and plundered the camp of the Arameans. It was then that a seah of fine flour sold for a shekel, and two seahs of barley sold for a shekel, according to the word of the LORD. [17] Now the king had appointed the officer on whose arm he leaned to be in charge of the gate, but the people trampled him in the gateway, and he died, just as the man of God had foretold when the king had come to him. [18] It happened just as the man of God had told the king: "About this time tomorrow at the gate of Samaria, two seahs of barley will sell for a shekel, and a seah of fine flour will sell for a shekel." [19] And the officer had answered the man of God, "Look, even if the LORD were to make windows in heaven, could this really happen?" So Elisha had replied, "You will see it with your own eyes, but you will not eat any of it!" [20] And that is just what happened to him. The people trampled him in the gateway, and he died.

8 Now Elisha had said to the woman whose son he had restored to life, "Arise, you and your household; go and live as a foreigner wherever you can. For the LORD has decreed a seven-year famine, and it has already come to the land." [2] So the woman had proceeded to do as the man of God had instructed. And she and her household lived as foreigners for seven years in the land of the Philistines. [3] At the end of seven years, when the woman returned from the land of the Philistines, she went to the king to appeal for her house and her land. [4] Now the king had been speaking to Gehazi, the servant of the man of God, saying, "Please relate to me all the great things Elisha has done." [5] And Gehazi was telling the king how Elisha had brought the dead back to life. Just then the woman whose son Elisha had revived came to appeal to the king for her house and her land. So Gehazi said, "My lord the king, this is the woman, and this is the son Elisha restored to life." [6] When the king asked the woman, she confirmed it. So the king appointed for her an officer, saying, "Restore all that was hers, along with all the proceeds of the field from the day that she left the country until now." [7] Then Elisha came to Damascus while Ben-hadad king of Aram was sick, and the king was told, "The man of God has come here." [8] So the king said to Hazael, "Take a gift in your hand, go to meet the man of God, and inquire of the LORD through him, 'Will I recover from this illness?'"

[9] So Hazael went to meet Elisha, taking with him a gift of forty camel loads of every good thing from Damascus. And he went in and stood before him and said, "Your son Ben-hadad king of Aram has sent me to ask, 'Will I recover from this illness?'" [10] Elisha answered, "Go and tell him, 'You will surely recover.' But the LORD has shown me that in fact he will die." [11] Elisha fixed his gaze steadily on him until Hazael became uncomfortable. Then the man of God began to weep.

[12] "Why is my lord weeping?" asked Hazael. "Because I know the evil you will do to the Israelites," Elisha replied. "You will set fire to their fortresses, kill their young men with the sword, dash their little ones to pieces, and rip open their pregnant women." [13] "But how could your servant, a mere dog, do such a monstrous thing?" said Hazael. And Elisha answered, "The LORD has shown me that you will be king over Aram." [14] So Hazael left Elisha and went to his master, who asked him, "What did Elisha say to you?" And he replied, "He told me that you would surely recover." [15] But the next day Hazael took a thick cloth, dipped it in water, and spread it over the king's face. So Ben-hadad died, and Hazael reigned in his place. [16] In the fifth year of the reign of Joram son of Ahab over Israel, Jehoram son of Jehoshaphat succeeded his father as king of Judah. [17] Jehoram was thirty-two years old when he became king, and he reigned in Jerusalem eight years. [18] And Jehoram walked in the ways of the kings of Israel, just as the house of Ahab had done. For he married a daughter of Ahab and did evil in the sight of the LORD.

[19] Yet for the sake of His servant David, the LORD was unwilling to destroy Judah, since He had promised to maintain a lamp for David and his descendants forever. [20] In the days of Jehoram, Edom rebelled against the hand of Judah and appointed their own king. [21] So Jehoram crossed over to Zair with all his chariots. When the

Edomites surrounded him and his chariot commanders, he rose up and attacked by night. His troops, however, fled to their homes. [22] So to this day Edom has been in rebellion against the hand of Judah. Likewise, Libnah rebelled at the same time. [23] As for the rest of the acts of Jehoram, along with all his accomplishments, are they not written in the book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah? [24] And Jehoram rested with his fathers and was buried with them in the City of David. And his son Ahaziah reigned in his place. [25] In the twelfth year of the reign of Joram son of Ahab over Israel, Ahaziah son of Jehoram became king of Judah. [26] Ahaziah was twenty-two years old when he became king, and he reigned in Jerusalem one year. His mother's name was Athaliah, the granddaughter of Omri king of Israel. [27] And Ahaziah walked in the ways of the house of Ahab and did evil in the sight of the LORD like the house of Ahab, for he was a son-in-law of the house of Ahab. [28] Then Ahaziah went with Joram son of Ahab to fight against Hazael king of Aram at Ramoth-gilead, and the Arameans wounded Joram. [29] So King Joram returned to Jezreel to recover from the wounds that the Arameans had inflicted on him at Ramah when he fought against Hazael king of Aram. Then Ahaziah son of Jehoram king of Judah went down to Jezreel to visit Joram son of Ahab, because Joram had been wounded.

9 Now Elisha the prophet summoned one of the sons of the prophets and said to him, "Tuck your cloak under your belt, take this flask of oil, and go to Ramoth-gilead." [2] When you arrive, look for Jehu son of Jehoshaphat, the son of Nimshi. Go in, get him away from his companions, and take him to an inner room. [3] "Then take the flask of oil, pour it on his head, and declare, 'This is what the LORD says: I anoint you king over Israel.' Then open the door and run. Do not delay!" [4] So the young prophet went to Ramoth-gilead, [5] and when he arrived, the army commanders were sitting there. "I have a message for you, commander," he said. "For which of us?" asked Jehu. "For you, commander," he replied. [6] So Jehu got up and went into the house, where the young prophet poured the oil on his head and declared, "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'I anoint you king over the LORD's people Israel.'" [7] And you are to strike down the house of your master Ahab, so that I may avenge the blood of My servants the prophets and the blood of all the servants of the LORD shed by the hand of Jezebel. [8] The whole house of Ahab will perish, and I will cut off from Ahab every male, both slave and free, in Israel. [9] I will make the house of Ahab like the houses of Jeroboam son of Nebat and Baasha son of Ahijah. [10] "And on the plot of ground at Jezreel the dogs will devour Jezebel, and there will be no one to bury her.'" Then the young prophet opened the door and ran. [11] When Jehu went out to the servants of his master, they asked, "Is everything all right? Why did this madman come to you?" "You know his kind and their babble," he replied.

[12] "That is a lie!" they said. "Tell us now!" So Jehu answered, "He talked to me about this and that, and he said, 'This is what the LORD says: I anoint you king over Israel.'" [13] Quickly, each man took his garment and put it under Jehu on the bare steps. Then they blew the ram's horn and proclaimed, "Jehu is king!" [14] Thus Jehu son of Jehoshaphat, the son of Nimshi, conspired against Joram. (Now Joram and all Israel had been defending Ramoth-gilead against Hazael king of Aram, [15] but King Joram had returned to Jezreel to recover from the wounds he had suffered at the hands of the Arameans in the battle against Hazael their king.) So Jehu said, "If you commanders wish to make me king, then do not let anyone escape from the city to go and tell it in Jezreel."

[16] Then Jehu got into his chariot and went to Jezreel, because Joram was laid up there and Ahaziah king of Judah had gone down to see him. [17] Now the watchman standing on the tower in Jezreel saw Jehu's troops approaching, and he called out, "I see a company of troops!" "Choose a rider," Joram commanded. "Send him out to meet them and ask, 'Have you come in peace?'" [18] So a horseman rode off to meet Jehu and said, "This is what the king asks: 'Have you come in peace?'" "What do you know about peace?" Jehu replied. "Fall in behind me." And the watchman reported, "The messenger reached them, but he is not coming back." [19] So the king sent out a second horseman, who went to them and said, "This is what the king asks: 'Have you come in peace?'" "What do you know about peace?" Jehu replied. "Fall in behind me." [20] Again the watchman reported, "He reached them, but he is not coming back. And the charioteer is driving like Jehu son of Nimshi—he is driving like a madman!" [21] "Harness!" Joram shouted, and they harnessed his chariot. Then Joram king of Israel and Ahaziah king of Judah set out, each in his own chariot, and met Jehu on the property of Naboth the Jezreelite. [22] When Joram saw Jehu, he asked, "Have you come in peace, Jehu?" "How can there be peace," he replied, "as long as the idolatry and witchcraft of your mother Jezebel abound?" [23] Joram turned around and fled, calling out to Ahaziah, "Treachery, Ahaziah!"

[24] Then Jehu drew his bow and shot Joram between the shoulders. The arrow pierced his heart, and he slumped down in his chariot. [25] And Jehu said to Bidkar his officer, "Pick him up and throw him into the field of Naboth the Jezreelite. For remember that when you and I were riding together behind his father Ahab, the LORD lifted up this burden against him:" [26] "'As surely as I saw the blood of Naboth and the blood of his sons yesterday, declares the LORD, so will I repay you on this plot of ground, declares the LORD.' Now then, according to the word of the LORD, pick him up and throw him on the plot of ground." [27] When King Ahaziah of Judah saw this, he fled up the road toward Beth-haggan. And Jehu pursued him, shouting, "Shoot him too!" So they shot Ahaziah in his chariot on the Ascent of Gur, near Ibleam, and he fled to Megiddo and died there. [28] Then his servants carried him by chariot to Jerusalem and buried him with his fathers in his tomb in the City of David. [29] (In the eleventh year of Joram son of Ahab, Ahaziah had become king over Judah.) [30] Now when Jehu arrived in Jezreel, Jezebel heard of it. So she painted her eyes, adorned her head, and looked down from a window. [31] And as Jehu entered the gate, she asked, "Have you come in peace, O Zimri, murderer of your master?" [32] He looked up at the window and called out, "Who is on my side? Who?" And two or three eunuchs looked down at him. [33] "Throw her down!" yelled Jehu. So they threw her down, and her blood splattered on the wall and on the horses as they trampled her underfoot. [34] Then Jehu went in and ate and drank. "Take care of this cursed woman," he said, "and bury her, for she was the daughter of a king." [35] But when they went out to bury her, they found nothing but her skull, her feet, and the palms of her hands. [36] So they went back and told Jehu, who replied, "This is the word of the LORD, which He spoke through His servant Elijah the Tishbite: 'On the plot of ground at Jezreel the dogs will devour the flesh of Jezebel.'" [37] "And Jezebel's body will lie like dung in the field on the plot of ground at Jezreel, so that no one can say: This is Jezebel.'"

10 Now Ahab had seventy sons in Samaria. So Jehu wrote letters and sent them to Samaria to the officials of Jezreel, to the elders, and to the guardians of the sons of Ahab, saying: [2] "When this letter arrives, since your master's sons are with you and you have chariots and horses, a fortified city and weaponry," [3] "select the best and most worthy son of your master, set him on his father's throne, and fight for your master's house." [4] But they were terrified and reasoned, "If two kings could not stand against him, how can we?" [5] So the palace administrator, the overseer of the city, the elders, and the guardians sent a message to Jehu: "We are your servants, and we will do whatever you say. We will not make anyone king. Do whatever is good in your sight." [6] Then Jehu wrote them a second letter and said: "If you are on my side, and if you will obey me, then bring the heads of your master's sons to me at Jezreel by this time tomorrow." Now the sons of the king, seventy in all, were being brought up by the leading men of the city. [7] And when the letter arrived, they took the sons of the king and slaughtered all seventy of them. They put their heads in baskets and sent them to Jehu at Jezreel. [8] When the messenger arrived, he told Jehu, "They have brought the heads of the sons of the king." And Jehu ordered, "Pile them in two heaps at the entrance of the gate until morning." [9] The next morning, Jehu went out and stood before all the people and said, "You are innocent. It was I who conspired against my master and killed him. But who killed all these?" [10] "Know, then, that not a word the LORD has spoken against the house of Ahab will fail, for the LORD has done what He promised through His servant Elijah." [11] So Jehu killed everyone in Jezreel who remained of the house of Ahab, as well as all his great men and close friends and priests, leaving him without a single survivor.

[12] Then Jehu set out toward Samaria. At Beth-eked of the Shepherds, [13] Jehu met some relatives of Ahaziah king of Judah and asked, "Who are you?" "We are relatives of Ahaziah," they answered, "and we have come down to greet the sons of the king and of the queen mother." [14] Then Jehu ordered, "Take them alive." So his men took them alive, then slaughtered them at the well of Beth-eked—forty-two men. He spared none of them. [15] When he left there, he found Jehonadab son of Rechab, who was coming to meet him. Jehu greeted him and asked, "Is your heart as true to mine as my heart is to yours?" "It is!" Jehonadab replied. "If it is," said Jehu, "give me your hand." So he gave him his hand, and Jehu helped him into his chariot, [16] saying, "Come with me and see my zeal for the LORD!" So he had him ride in his chariot. [17] When Jehu came to Samaria, he struck down everyone belonging to Ahab who remained there, until he had destroyed them, according to the word that the LORD had spoken to Elijah. [18] Then Jehu brought all the people together and said, "Ahab served Baal a little, but Jehu will serve him a lot." [19] "Now, therefore, summon to me all the prophets of Baal, all his servants, and all his priests. See that no one is missing, for I have a great sacrifice for Baal. Whoever is missing will not live." But Jehu was acting deceptively in order to destroy the servants of Baal.

[20] And Jehu commanded, "Proclaim a solemn assembly for Baal." So they announced it. [21] Then Jehu sent word throughout Israel, and all the servants of Baal came; there was not a man who failed to show. They entered the temple of Baal, and it was filled from end to end. [22] And Jehu said to the keeper of the wardrobe, "Bring out garments for all the servants of Baal." So he brought out garments for them. [23] Next, Jehu and Jehonadab son of Rechab entered the temple of Baal, and Jehu said to the servants of Baal, "Look around to see that there are no servants of the LORD here among you—only servants of Baal."

[24] And they went in to offer sacrifices and burnt offerings. Now Jehu had stationed eighty men outside and warned them, "If anyone allows one of the men I am delivering into your hands to escape, he will forfeit his life for theirs." [25] When he had finished making the burnt offering, Jehu said to the guards and officers, "Go in and kill them. Do not let anyone out." So the guards and officers put them to the sword, threw the bodies out, and went into the inner room of the temple of Baal. [26] They brought out the sacred pillar of the temple of Baal and burned it. [27] They also demolished the sacred pillar of Baal. Then they tore down the temple of Baal

and made it into a latrine, which it is to this day. [28] Thus Jehu eradicated Baal from Israel, [29] but he did not turn away from the sins that Jeroboam son of Nebat had caused Israel to commit—the worship of the golden calves at Bethel and Dan. [30] Nevertheless, the LORD said to Jehu, "Because you have done well in carrying out what is right in My sight and have done to the house of Ahab all that was in My heart, four generations of your sons will sit on the throne of Israel." [31] Yet Jehu was not careful to follow the instruction of the LORD, the God of Israel, with all his heart. He did not turn away from the sins that Jeroboam had caused Israel to commit. [32] In those days the LORD began to reduce the size of Israel. Hazael defeated the Israelites throughout their territory [33] from the Jordan eastward through all the land of Gilead (the region of Gad, Reuben, and Manasseh), and from Aroer by the Arnon Valley through Gilead to Bashan. [34] As for the rest of the acts of Jehu, along with all his accomplishments and all his might, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel? [35] And Jehu rested with his fathers and was buried in Samaria, and his son Jehoahaz reigned in his place. [36] So the duration of Jehu's reign over Israel in Samaria was twenty-eight years.

11 When Athaliah the mother of Ahaziah saw that her son was dead, she proceeded to annihilate all the royal heirs. [2] But Jehosheba daughter of King Joram, the sister of Ahaziah, took Joash son of Ahaziah and stole him away from among the sons of the king who were being murdered. She put him and his nurse in a bedroom to hide him from Athaliah, and he was not killed. [3] And Joash remained hidden with his nurse in the house of the LORD for six years while Athaliah ruled the land. [4] Then in the seventh year, Jehoiada sent for the commanders of hundreds, the Carites, and the guards, and had them brought into the house of the LORD. There he made a covenant with them and put them under oath. He showed them the king's son [5] and commanded them, "This is what you are to do: A third of you who come on duty on the Sabbath shall guard the royal palace," [6] a third shall be at the gate of Sur, and a third at the gate behind the guards. You are to take turns guarding the temple—

[7] the two divisions that would go off duty on the Sabbath are to guard the house of the LORD for the king. [8] "You must surround the king with weapons in hand, and anyone who approaches the ranks must be put to death. You must stay close to the king wherever he goes." [9] So the commanders of hundreds did everything that Jehoiada the priest had ordered. Each of them took his men—those coming on duty on the Sabbath and those going off duty—and came to Jehoiada the priest.

[10] Then the priest gave to the commanders of hundreds the spears and shields of King David from the house of the LORD. [11] And the guards stood with weapons in hand surrounding the king by the altar and the temple, from the south side to the north side of the temple. [12] Then Jehoiada brought out the king's son, put the crown on him, presented him with the Testimony, and proclaimed him king. They anointed him, and the people clapped their hands and declared, "Long live the king!" [13] When Athaliah heard the noise from the guards and the people, she went out to the people in the house of the LORD.

[14] And she looked out and saw the king standing by the pillar, according to the custom. The officers and trumpeters were beside the king, and all the people of the land were rejoicing and blowing trumpets. Then Athaliah tore her clothes and screamed, "Treason! Treason!" [15] And Jehoiada the priest ordered the commanders of hundreds in charge of the army, "Bring her out between the ranks, and put to the sword anyone who follows her." For the priest had said, "She must not be put to death in the house of the LORD." [16] So they seized Athaliah as she reached the horses' entrance to the palace grounds, and there she was put to death. [17] Then Jehoiada made a covenant between the LORD and the king and the people that they would be the LORD's people. He also made a covenant between the king and the people. [18] So all the people of the land went to the temple of Baal and tore it down. They smashed the altars and idols to pieces, and they killed Mattan the priest of Baal in front of the altars. And Jehoiada the priest posted guards for the house of the LORD. [19] He took with him the commanders of hundreds, the Carites, the guards, and all the people of the land, and they brought the king down from the house of the LORD and entered the royal palace by way of the Gate of the Guards. Then Joash took his seat on the royal throne, [20] and all the people of the land rejoiced. And the city was quiet, because Athaliah had been put to the sword at the royal palace. [21] Joash was seven years old when he became king.

12 In the seventh year of Jehu, Joash became king, and he reigned in Jerusalem forty years. His mother's name was Zibiah; she was from Beersheba. [2] And Joash did what was right in the eyes of the LORD all the days he was instructed by Jehoiada the priest. [3] Nevertheless, the high places were not removed; the people continued sacrificing and burning incense there. [4] Then Joash said to the priests, "Collect all the money brought as sacred gifts into the house of the LORD—the census money, the money from vows, and the money brought voluntarily into the house of the LORD." [5] "Let every priest receive it from his constituency, and let it be used to repair any damage found in the temple." [6] By the twenty-third year of the reign of Joash, however, the priests had not yet repaired the damage to the temple.

[7] So King Joash called Jehoiada and the other priests and said, "Why have you not repaired the damage to the temple? Now, therefore, take no more money from your constituency, but hand it over for the repair of the temple." [8] So the priests agreed that they would not receive money from the people and that they would not repair the temple themselves. [9] Then Jehoiada the priest took a chest, bored a hole in its lid, and set it beside the altar on the right side as one enters the house of the LORD. There the priests who guarded the threshold put all the money brought into the house of the LORD.

[10] Whenever they saw that there was a large amount of money in the chest, the royal scribe and the high priest would go up, count the money brought into the house of the LORD, and tie it up in bags. [11] Then they would put the counted money into the hands of those who supervised the work on the house of the LORD, who in turn would pay those doing the work—the carpenters, builders, [12] masons, and stonecutters. They also purchased timber and dressed stone to repair the damage to the house of the LORD, and they paid the other expenses of the temple repairs. [13] However, the money brought into the house of the LORD was not used for making silver basins, wick trimmers, sprinkling bowls, trumpets, or any articles of gold or silver for the house of the LORD.

[14] Instead, it was paid to those doing the work, and with it they repaired the house of the LORD. [15] No accounting was required from the men who received the money to pay the workmen, because they acted with integrity. [16] The money from the guilt offerings and sin offerings was not brought into the house of the LORD; it belonged to the priests. [17] At that time Hazael king of Aram marched up and fought against Gath and captured it. Then he decided to attack Jerusalem. [18] So King Joash of Judah took all the sacred objects dedicated by his fathers —Jehoshaphat, Jehoram, and Ahaziah, the kings of Judah—along with his own consecrated items and all the gold found in the treasuries of the house of the LORD and the royal palace, and he sent them to Hazael king of Aram. So Hazael withdrew from Jerusalem. [19] As for the rest of the acts of Joash, along with all his accomplishments, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah? [20] And the servants of Joash rose up and formed a conspiracy and killed him at Beth-millo, on the road down to Silla. [21] His servants Jozabad son of Shimeath and Jehozabad son of Shomer struck him down, and he died. And they buried him with his fathers in the City of David, and his son Amaziah reigned in his place.

13 In the twenty-third year of the reign of Joash son of Ahaziah over Judah, Jehoahaz son of Jehu became king of Israel, and he reigned in Samaria seventeen years. [2] And he did evil in the sight of the LORD and followed the sins that Jeroboam son of Nebat had caused Israel to commit; he did not turn away from them. [3] So the anger of the LORD burned against Israel, and He delivered them continually into the hands of Hazael king of Aram and his son Ben-hadad. [4] Then Jehoahaz sought the favor of the LORD, and the LORD listened to him because He saw the oppression that the king of Aram had inflicted on Israel. [5] So the LORD gave Israel a deliverer, and they escaped the power of the Arameans. Then the people of Israel lived in their own homes as they had before. [6] Nevertheless, they did not turn away from the sins that the house of Jeroboam had caused Israel to commit, but they continued to walk in them. The Asherah pole even remained standing in Samaria. [7] Jehoahaz had no army left, except fifty horsemen, ten chariots, and ten thousand foot soldiers, because the king of Aram had destroyed them and made them like the dust at threshing.

[8] As for the rest of the acts of Jehoahaz, along with all his accomplishments and his might, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel? [9] And Jehoahaz rested with his fathers and was buried in Samaria. And his son Jehoash reigned in his place. [10] In the thirty-seventh year of the reign of Joash over Judah, Jehoash son of Jehoahaz became king of Israel in Samaria, and he reigned sixteen years. [11] And he did evil in the sight of the LORD and did not turn away from all the sins that Jeroboam son of Nebat had caused Israel to commit, but he walked in them. [12] As for the rest of the acts of Jehoash, along with all his accomplishments and his might, including his war against Amaziah king of Judah, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel? [13] And Jehoash rested with his fathers, and Jeroboam succeeded him on the throne. Jehoash was buried in Samaria with the kings of Israel. [14] When Elisha had fallen sick with the illness from which he would die, Jehoash king of Israel came down to him and wept over him, saying, "My father, my father, the chariots and horsemen of Israel!" [15] Elisha told him, "Take a bow and some arrows." So Jehoash took a bow and some arrows.

[16] Then Elisha said to the king of Israel, "Put your hand on the bow." So the king put his hand on the bow, and Elisha put his hands on the king's hands. [17] "Open the east window," said Elisha. So he opened it and Elisha said, "Shoot!" So he shot. And Elisha declared: "This is the LORD's arrow of victory, the arrow of victory over Aram, for you shall strike the Arameans in Aphek until you have put an end to them." [18] Then Elisha said, "Take the arrows!" So he took them, and Elisha said to the king of Israel, "Strike the ground!" So he struck the ground three times and stopped. [19] But the man of God was angry with him and said, "You should have struck the ground five or six times. Then you would have struck down Aram until you had put an end to it. But now you will strike down Aram only three times."

[20] And Elisha died and was buried. Now the Moabite raiders used to come into the
land every spring. [21] Once, as the Israelites were burying a man, suddenly they saw
a band of raiders, so they threw the man's body into Elisha's tomb. And as soon as
his body touched the bones of Elisha, the man was revived and stood up on his feet.